

AUSTRALIAN PROPERTY MARKET DATA · RESEARCHER BRIEFING

What Is the Domain Dataset, and What Can You Do With It?

An overview of the Domain property dataset: what it contains, how it is structured, and what research it can support.

Domain API via AURIN (Australian Urban Research Infrastructure Network)

Where does this data come from, and what is in it?

Domain.com.au is one of Australia's largest property listings websites. Agents post listings there and sale results are recorded, creating a continuously updated view of the market that researchers reach through **AURIN**.

- Properties currently for sale or rent
- Properties recently sold, with price and date
- Market conditions in each suburb over time

Not a one-time snapshot. Unlike a static dataset delivered as a file, this is a **live query service**. Questions are sent and answered in real time, so the data always reflects current market activity.



Suburb-Level Summaries

Market snapshots for each suburb: typical prices, how fast homes sell, rental demand, auction activity. Good for **trends, comparisons across areas, and policy analysis**.



Individual Property Records

Details on specific homes: bedrooms, sold price, date, description, coordinates. Useful for **fine-grained analysis, spatial modelling, or a single street**.

Rule of thumb: if your question is about a suburb or area, use the summaries; if it is about specific properties or transactions, use the individual listings.

Suburb-Level Summaries: What's in Them?

Snapshots per suburb at quarterly, half-yearly, and annual intervals, over a rolling window of roughly the last decade. Houses and units are queried separately.

What each period record contains

- **Median sold price:** the middle sale price for the period
- **Number of sales:** how many properties actually sold
- **Days on market:** how long homes typically sat before selling
- **Auction clearance rate:** share of auctions that resulted in a sale
- **Median asking rent:** typical advertised rental price
- **Rental yield:** annual rent as a percentage of property value
- **Price distribution:** 5th, 25th, 75th, 95th percentile prices
- **Discount rate:** how much sellers typically dropped their asking price

✓ Best for questions like...

"How have median house prices in Fitzroy changed over the last decade?"

"Which inner-Melbourne suburbs had the fastest-selling properties last year?"

"How did COVID affect rental demand in coastal areas?"

Individual Property Records: What's in Them?

Each record describes one property at one point in time (a sale, a rental listing, or an active for-sale listing).

What each property record contains

- **Address and coordinates:** exact location (lat/lon)
- **Property type:** house, apartment, townhouse, etc.
- **Size:** bedrooms, bathrooms, car spaces, land area
- **Price or rent:** sold price, asking price, or rental amount
- **Sold date:** when the transaction occurred
- **Sale method:** auction, private treaty, or expression of interest
- **Agency:** which real estate agency handled the sale
- **Features and amenities:** tags declared by the advertiser (e.g. swimming pool, air conditioning, ensuite, balcony, solar panels, water views, pet-friendly) across 41 possible attributes

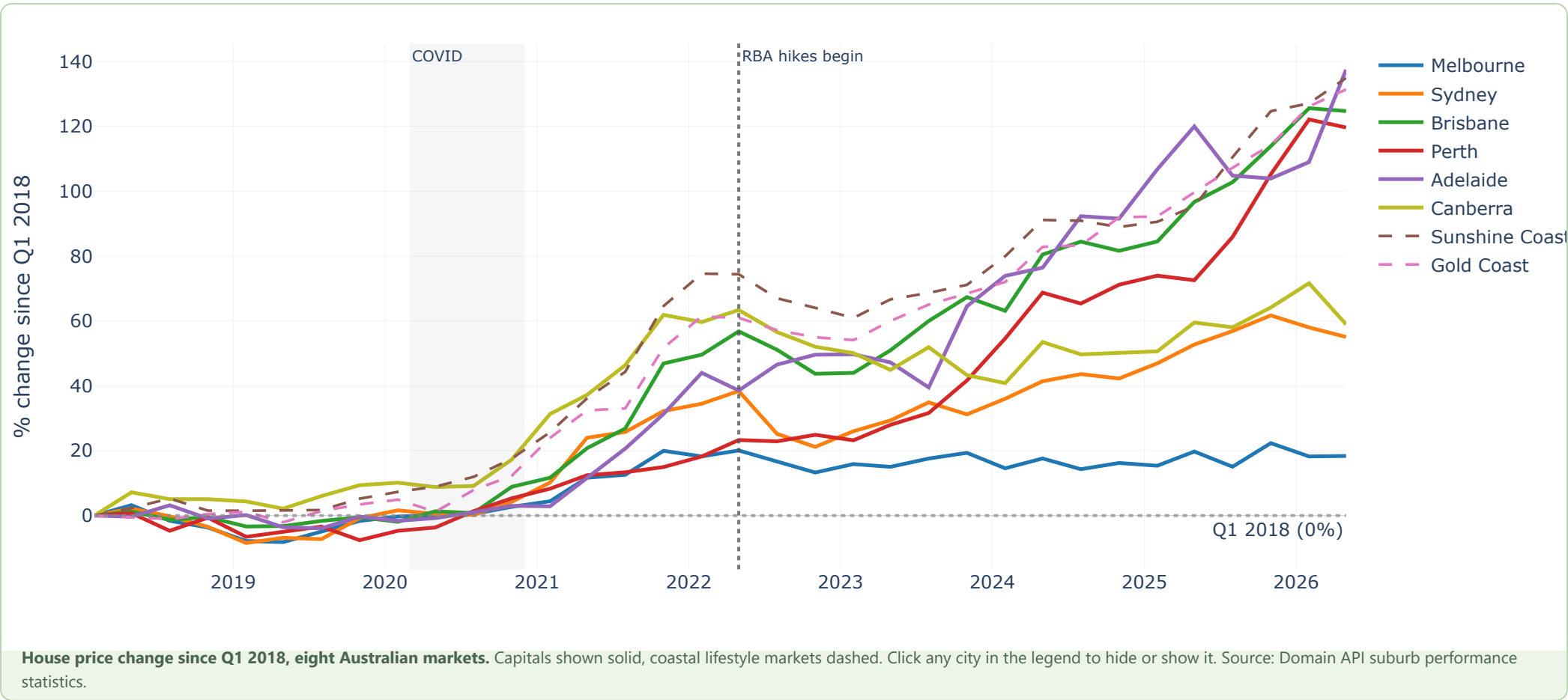


Heads up on coverage

Individual records are **densely available from 2018 onwards**. Earlier years (2000-2018) exist but the data might be sparse. Do not rely on pre-2018 completeness for research that needs every transaction.

Example: Price Trends Across Australian Markets

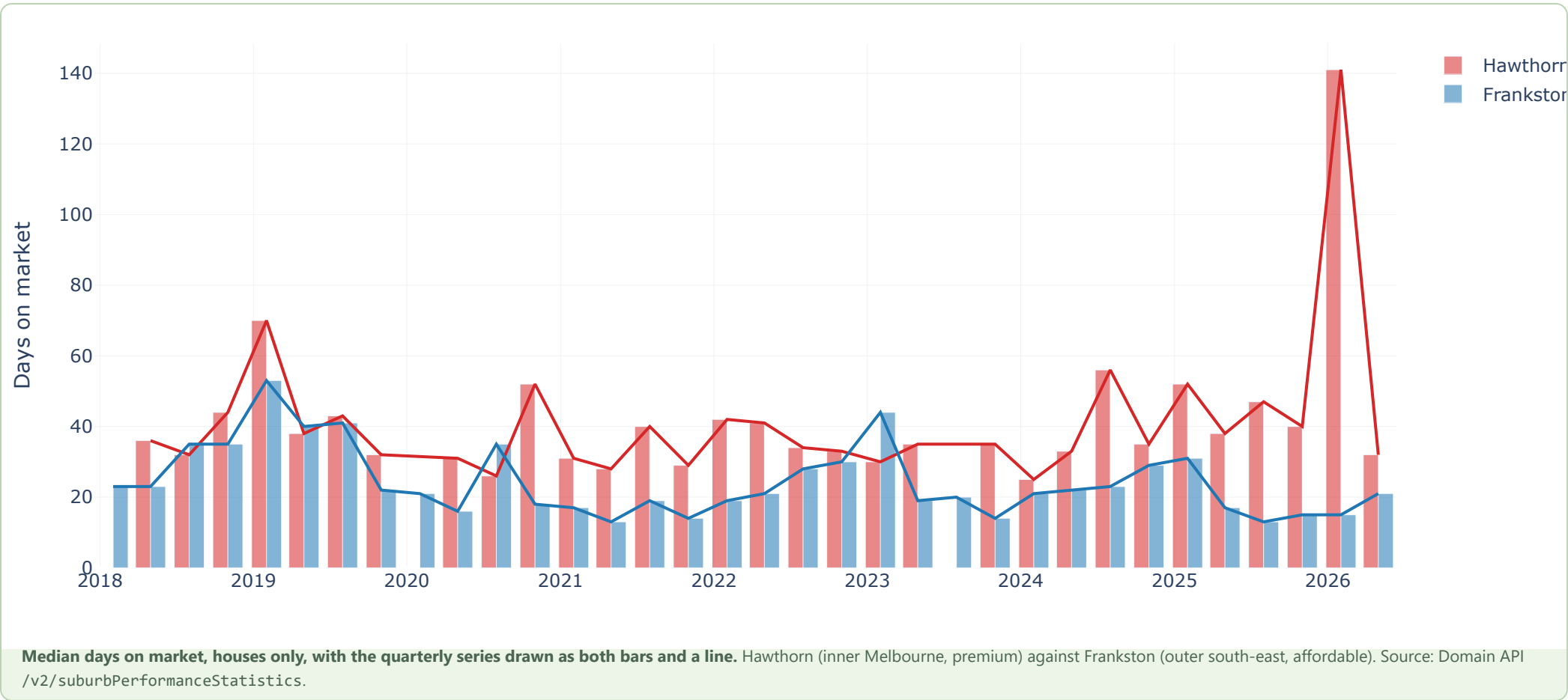
All markets indexed to Q1 2018, so they can be compared regardless of their absolute price levels. Capitals are solid, coastal lifestyle markets dashed.



Built from suburb-level summary data: a sample of 30 suburbs per city spanning its price range, taken as the median of those suburb medians each quarter. Houses in Brisbane, Perth, Adelaide and both Queensland coasts roughly doubled since 2018; Sydney rose 55% and Melbourne just 18%.

Example: How Long Properties Take to Sell

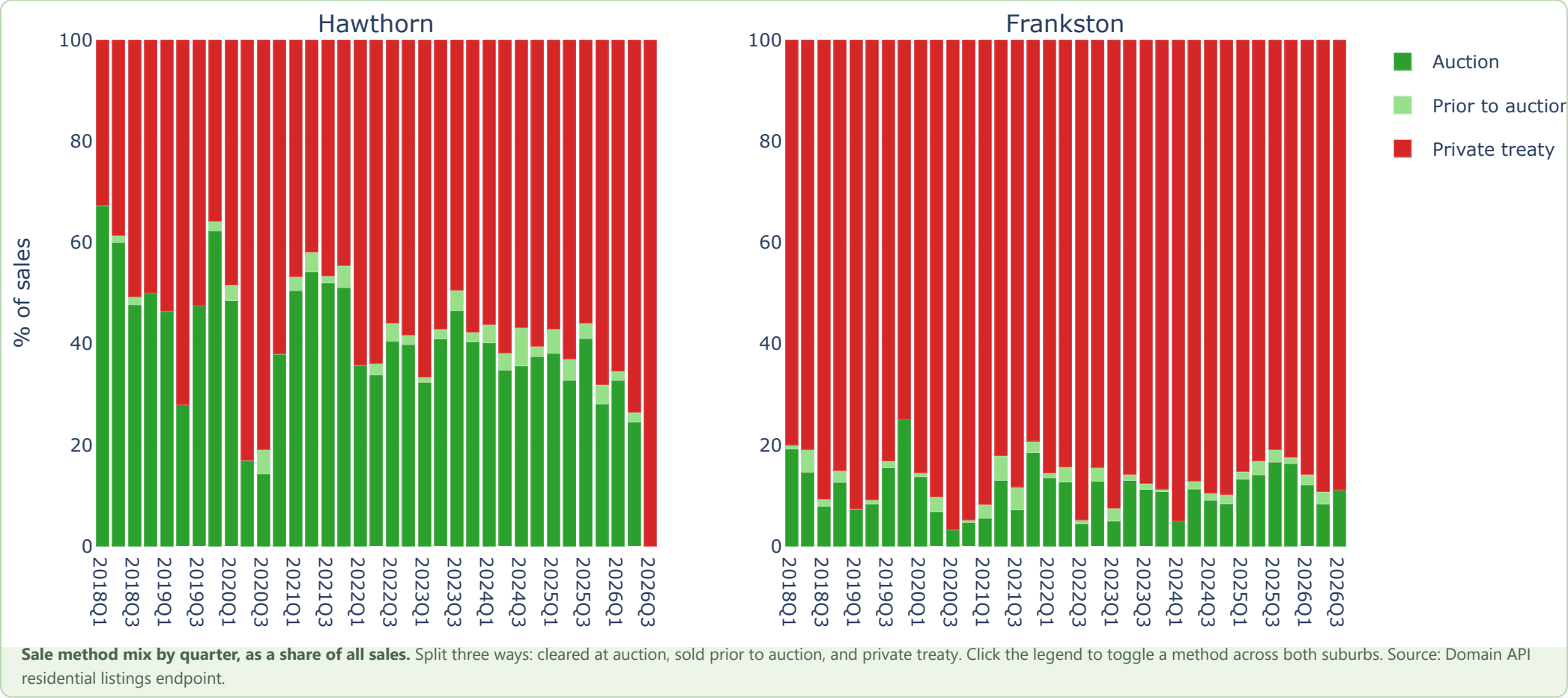
"Days on market" measures how long a typical property sits before a buyer is found. A low number signals a hot market; a high number signals a buyer's market.



The same suburb-level data that gives you median prices also gives you this demand signal. The reliable reading here is the gap in level between the two suburbs, not the trend within either: a Frankston house sells in about three weeks, a Hawthorn house in about five.

Example: How Properties Are Sold

The mix of auctions vs private sales shifts with market conditions and differs sharply between suburbs.



Hawthorn leans on auctions; Frankston defaults to private treaty, where conditional contracts suit first-home buyers. Only Hawthorn's mix moves, drifting down roughly ten points after 2022, while Frankston's holds steady.

What the data covers: where, and how far back

All Australian states and territories, across every suburb with activity on Domain's platform. How far back you can go depends on which part of the dataset you need.

 **All suburbs covered**

Query by suburb name and postcode. Cities, regional centres and most rural areas with listing activity are included; coverage thins in very remote areas.

 **ABS area mapping**

Domain uses suburb names and postcodes, not ABS statistical areas (SA2, SA3, SA4). Correspondence files convert between the two, but it is an extra step.

 **Spatial queries**

You can draw a polygon on a map and retrieve the listings inside it. Useful for corridor studies, catchments and irregular boundaries, but any single query returns at most 1,000 records and truncates silently beyond that.

Rolling ~10 yrs

Suburb summaries

Quarterly, half-yearly and annual statistics on a rolling window, capped at 45 periods and starting February 2015. Longer intervals do not reach further back. The most complete series, though Domain suppresses low-volume suburb quarters.

2018 onward

Individual listings (reliable)

Densely covered from 2018, and suitable for transaction-level research from that point.

2000-2018

Individual listings (sparse)

Records exist but many are missing. Not reliable where complete market coverage is required.

2011, 2016, 2021

Demographics

Suburb-level Census profiles, available for Census years only.

How does access work?

Access is managed by AURIN and is available to approved researchers at Australian universities and research organisations.

5,000

API credits per month

1

credit per query

1st

of each month, resets

How a query works

- You translate a specific question (e.g., give me suburb statistics for Fitzroy, 2020-2024) to an API query.
- The system returns the data instantly and deducts from your credit balance. **Every call costs one credit, including one that returns nothing**, so a typo in a suburb name is charged like any other query.

Credits are a finite monthly resource. Scoping queries around a defined research question ensures the allowance goes toward the data the study actually needs, rather than broad exploratory calls.



Getting access

Approval through a breakthrough opportunity (or a relevant activity under your Node AAP), signing the AURIN data transfer agreement, then collecting your credentials. A full setup guide is available in the training materials.

What this data can and cannot do

A quick reference to check before designing a study around this source.

Research need	Covered?
Suburb-level price trends over the last decade	Yes
Individual sold property records from 2018 onwards	Yes
Current rental listings (live snapshot on the query day)	Yes
Historical rental listings	No (the search endpoint is live only)
Days on market, auction rates, sale method	Yes
Suburb demographics (Census years)	Yes
Suburb statistics older than the rolling window	No (nothing before Feb 2015)
Complete listing records before 2018	No (very sparse)
Bulk download of all records for a state	No (query by query only)
SA2 / SA3 / SA4 aggregations out of the box	Partial (requires a mapping step)
Original asking price after a property has sold	No (overwritten on sale)
Properties not listed on Domain.com.au	No (Domain-only market view)

What you can publish is a separate question

Everything above is about what you can *retrieve*. Domain treats internal analysis and published output as two different stages, and the second one carries restrictions.

 **Stage one: internal research**

Use the data freely to develop hypotheses, analyse, identify trends and inform your work. Nothing below constrains this.

 **Stage two: anything public**

Publishing, distributing or commercialising findings outside your internal environment **needs Domain's review and approval**. There is no definitive list of what will pass, so raise the use case early rather than at submission.

In a published output	Typically
Listing descriptions	Not allowed
Property images	One hero image
Agent names and phone numbers	Not allowed
A property's full listing history	Latest sale only
Anything supporting direct marketing	Not allowed
Aggregates and area-level findings	Unrestricted

Which agreement you are under also matters. The **API agreement** covers applied research, academic publication and internal non-commercial proofs of concept. The **sample data agreement**, which governs the static sample datasets, is **internal evaluation only** and excludes research and publication outright.

The rule to design around. The restricted elements are **research inputs only**. They may inform the analysis, but they should not appear in published outputs. Report the property market outcomes rather than the images, descriptions, agent details or unit-level history that produced them.

Questions?

Training materials, worked examples, and a credit cost calculator are available in the accompanying guides and Jupyter notebooks. Start with the Getting Started guide.

Domain API · Accessed via AURIN · Data from Domain.com.au